

Murat Abus

Department of Government, Law & Policy | Arkansas State University

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Employment & Affiliations

Postdoctoral Fellow in Political Science

Arkansas State University

Jonesboro, AR

2026-present

Affiliate Researcher at the Institute for Rural Initiatives

Arkansas State University

Jonesboro, AR

2026-present

Affiliate Researcher at the Institute for Democracy, Journalism and Citizenship

Syracuse University

Washington, D.C.

2026-present

Education

Ph.D. in Political Science

Syracuse University

Syracuse, NY

2026

M.A. in Political Science

Arkansas State University

Jonesboro, AR

2021

B.A. in Political Science

Bogazici University

Istanbul, Turkey

1998

Research

Publications

* indicates equal authorship; author order is alphabetical

Journal Articles

5. **Murat Abus** and Sabri Ciftci. 2026. "Administrative Unit Proliferation in Parliamentary Systems: Evidence from Turkish Elections, 1960-2018." *Electoral Studies* 101: 103087.
4. **Murat Abus** and Kexin Bai and Johanna Dunaway. 2025. "Local News, Partisanship, and Perceptions About Election Administration." *Electoral Studies* 97: 102970.
3. **Murat Abus**. 2025. "The Gendered Politics of Candidate Selection: An Analysis of Left-Right Preferences in Parliamentary Democracies." *Political Research Quarterly* 78 (3): 1060-1073.
2. **Murat Abus**. 2024. "A Theory of Gender's Effect on Vote Shift with a Test Based on Turkish Elections." *Mediterranean Politics* 29 (5): 729-754.
1. **Murat Abus**. 2003. "Democratization in the Balkans, 1990-2002." *Alternatives: Turkish Journal of International Relations* 2 (3&4): 86-105.

Works in Progress

7. **Murat Abus**. "Electoral Consequences of Administrative Reforms." (under review).

6. **Murat Abus** and Cameron Wimpy. "Nationalization of Local Elections." (under review).
5. Cameron Wimpy and **Murat Abus**. "Turnout in Local Elections."
4. **Murat Abus** and Johanna Dunaway. "Local News and Political Competition."
3. Sabri Ciftci and **Murat Abus**. "Municipalities and Territorial Reforms in the Context of Authoritarianism."
2. **Murat Abus** and Cameron Wimpy. "Local Media Access and Voter Confidence."
1. **Murat Abus** and Kexin Bai. "A New Look at Voter Confidence."

Research Interests

Political Behavior; Election Science; Political Communication; Public Opinion; Comparative Public Administration; Local Politics; Local News; Democracy and Autocracy

Conference Presentations

"Local Media Access and Voter Confidence"

Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Cameron Wimpy)

St. Pete, FL

January 2027

"Municipalities and Territorial Reforms in the Context of Authoritarianism"

Southern Political Science Association Annual Meetin (with Sabri Ciftci)

St. Pete, FL

January 2027

"Left in the Dark: Local Newspaper Closure and Rural Political Disengagement"

Election Sciences, Reform, and Administration Conference (with Cameron Wimpy)

Phoenix, AZ

June 2026

"The Nonstationary Geography of Nationalization in American Elections, 2000-2024"

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Cameron Wimpy)

Chicago, IL

April 2026

"Local News and Political Competition"

National Capital Area Political Science Association American Politics Workshop (with Johanna Dunaway)

Washington, D.C.

January 2026

"Social Context, Unemployment, and Local News: A New Look at Voter Confidence"

Election Sciences, Reform, and Administration Conference (with Johanna Dunaway)

Tallahassee, FL

June 2025

"Uncontested Elections and Declining Local News"

Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior Conference (with Johanna Dunaway)

Stony Brook, NY

May 2025

"Local News Effects on Down-Ballot Electoral Competition"

Mini Conference on Information and Messages in Sociopolitical Life (with Johanna Dunaway)

Houston, TX

May 2025

"Local News and Minority and Women Candidate Emergence"

Gender, Race, and Ethnicity Politics Workshop (with Johanna Dunaway and Paru Shah)

Washington, D.C.

May 2025

"Subnational Unit Proliferation and Electoral Dynamics: The Case of Turkey"

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Sabri Ciftci)

Chicago, IL

April 2025

"Local News Declines, Incumbency Effects and the Electoral Fortunes of Women and Candidates of Color"

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Johanna Dunaway and Paru Shah)

Chicago, IL

April 2025

"Local News and the Down-Ballot Incumbency Advantage" Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Johanna Dunaway)	Chicago, IL April 2025
"Social Context, Unemployment, and Local News: A New Look at Voter Confidence" Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Johanna Dunaway)	Chicago, IL April 2025
"Political Economy of Demographic Aging: New Pressures on Voter Turnout" Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Margarita Estévez-Abe)	Chicago, IL April 2025
"Electoral Consequences of Administrative Unit Proliferation: Evidence from Turkey" Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting	Chicago, IL April 2025
"Spatial Analysis of News Deserts: The Distribution of U.S. Local Newspapers" Local Journalism Researchers Workshop (with Johanna Dunaway)	Durham, NC March 2025
"Government Type, Electoral Dynamics, and Subnational Unit Proliferation in Turkey" PSA Turkish Politics Online Workshop (with Sabri Ciftci)	Virtual presentation February 2025
"Local Media and Voter Confidence" Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Johanna Dunaway)	San Juan, PR January 2025
"Local News and the Down-Ballot Incumbency Advantage" American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Johanna Dunaway)	Philadelphia, PA September 2024
"Media Access and Perceptions of Election Administration" Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Kexin Bai and Johanna Dunaway)	Chicago, IL April 2024
"Inequality, Local Media, and Voter Confidence" Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Kexin Bai and Johanna Dunaway)	Chicago, IL April 2024
"Variety of Women Candidates in Parliamentary Democracies" Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Sarah A. Fulton)	Chicago, IL April 2024
"Subnational Unit Proliferation: Evidence from Turkey" Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting	Chicago, IL April 2024
"Local Media Access and Perceptions of Election Integrity" Local News Researchers Workshop (with Kexin Bai and Johanna Dunaway)	Durham, NC March 2024
"Media, Partisanship, and Election Integrity" Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior Conference (with Kexin Bai and Johanna Dunaway)	Tallahassee, FL March 2024
"Media Access and Perceptions of Election Administration" Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Kexin Bai and Johanna Dunaway)	New Orleans, LA January 2024
"Variety of Women Candidates in Parliamentary Democracies" Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Sarah A. Fulton)	New Orleans, LA January 2024
"Partisanship and Election Administration" Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting	New Orleans, LA January 2024

"Inequality and Voter Confidence in American Elections" Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting	New Orleans, LA January 2024
"Reforming and Backsliding: A Comparative Analysis of Administrative Reforms in Hungary and Turkey" Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting	Chicago, IL April 2023
"Reforming and Backsliding: A Comparative Analysis of Administrative Reforms in Hungary and Turkey (poster presentation)" Texas Comparative Politics Circle Annual Conference	Lubbock, TX January 2023
"Electoral Consequences of Administrative Reforms in Turkey (1985-2018)" Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting	St. Pete, FL January 2023
"Electoral Consequences of Administrative Reforms (poster presentation)" Southern Workshop in Empirical Political Science	Houston, TX May 2022
"Democracy at the Intersection of Religious Cleavage and Populism" Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting	Virtual presentation April 2022
"Ideology and Gender Role Incongruity: Resilience and Rise of Parties under Authoritarianism (poster presentation)" Texas Comparative Politics Circle Annual Conference	Austin, TX February 2022
"Ideology and Gender Role Incongruity: The Rise of IYI Party in Perspective" Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting	San Antonio, TX January 2022
"Clientelism and Structured Voting: Evidence from Turkey" Southwestern Social Science Association Annual Meeting	virtual presentation April 2021
"Are We There Yet? Political Participation in Transitional Democracies" Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (with Cameron Wimpy)	Virtual presentation April 2021
"Do Elections Create or Further Path Dependencies?" Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting	Virtual presentation April 2021
"Election Administration and UOCAVA Voting" Arkansas Political Science Association Annual Meeting	Virtual presentation February 2021
"Clientelism and Structured Voting: Evidence from Turkey" Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting	Virtual presentation January 2021
"Reflections in the Mirror: Authoritarian Values and Political Identities in Turkey" Arkansas Political Science Association	Arkadelphia, AR March 2020
"A Model of Voter Turnout in Bulgaria and Romania" Graduate Conference of Turkish Political Science Association	Istanbul, Turkey October 2004
"Democratization in the Balkans, 1990-2002" Graduate Conference of Turkish Political Science Association	Istanbul, Turkey October 2003

Teaching

Teaching Interests

Introduction to Data Analysis; Applied Data Analysis; Advanced Data Analysis; Data Visualization; Comparative Politics; Political Behavior; Election Science; Local Elections and Local Politics; Authoritarianism & Populism; Media and Politics; Political Psychology; Comparing Democracies / Comparative Political Behavior; Public Opinion and Political Parties; Russian State & Politics; Politics of Developing Countries

Courses & Workshops Taught

PLSC 40303, Terrorism and Political Violence

Arkansas State University

Spring 2027

PLSC 20003, Introduction to US Government

Arkansas State University

Spring 2027

PLSC 34053, Introduction to Political Analysis

Arkansas State University

Fall 2026

PLSC 33203, Introduction to Comparative Politics

Arkansas State University

Fall 2026

PLSC 66003, Advanced Political Analysis

Arkansas State University

Fall 2026

Fellowships, Honors & Awards

Graduate research assistantship

Syracuse University

2024–2026

Outstanding Graduate Student

Political Science Department, Arkansas State University

2021

Graduate research/teaching assistantship

Arkansas State University

2019–2021

Professional Memberships & Service

Peer Reviewer

Political Research Quarterly (6), *Electoral Studies* (1), *Political Communication* (1), *Politics and Religion* (1), *Mediterranean Politics* (1), *Electronic News* (1)

Panel Discussant

2022 MPSA, 2027 SPSA

Panel Chair

2022 MPSA, 2024 MPSA, 2025 SPSA, 2026 MPSA

Skills & Software

Languages

English (Fluent), Turkish (Native), Russian (Upper Intermediate B2)

Methods

Spatial Econometrics, Matching Analysis, Survival Analysis, Panel Data

Software

R, Stata, $\text{\LaTeX}$, GeoDa, Qualtrics

Certifications

Russian Language Certification

Privet Language School, Kaliningrad, Russia

2014

Research Methodology & Software Workshops

From Text to Insights: Building and Analyzing Custom Political Event Data

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods

2025

Stata Courses for Panel Data, Survival Analysis, and Programming

StataCorp

2025

Professional References

Dr. Sabri Ciftci

Professor of Political Science
Michael W. Suleiman Chair in Arab and Arab-American Studies
Kansas State University
📍 Manhattan, KS 66506
✉ ciftci@ksu.edu

Dr. Johanna Dunaway

Professor of Political Science
Research Director at Institute for Democracy, Journalism, and
Citizenship
Syracuse University
📍 Washington, D.C. 20036
✉ jldunawa@syr.edu

Dr. William P. McLean

Interim Provost and Executive Vice Chancellor
Academic Affairs and Research
Arkansas State University
📍 State University, AR 72467
✉ wmclean@astate.edu

Dr. Michelle Taylor-Robinson

Professor, Mays Family Foundation Building Democracy Chair
Associate Dean for Research & Graduate Education
Texas A&M University
📍 College Station, TX 77843
✉ m-taylor11@tamu.edu

Dr. Emily Thorson

Associate Professor of Political Science
Syracuse University
📍 Syracuse, NY 13244
✉ ethorson@gmail.com

Dr. Cameron Wimpy

Associate Professor and Department Chair
Department of Government, Law & Policy
Arkansas State University
📍 State University, AR 72467
✉ cwimpy@astate.edu